"Grandfather, it is me. There will be a time, I will come, you will hear my voice, you will live forever." They could hear voices of women and men trilling. Then came a heartbeat and all the animals came and danced, all the birds and insects and lightning came out of the earth. The stone people came out of the water and danced. Trees and plants came out and danced and they healed the people. The rhythm regulated their heartbeats and they began to shake as if they were electrified. It was the rhythm of the drum that did the healing. They kept drumming and hearing all the sounds of the earth in the drum. The drum became a sacred way and everyone gathered around the drum and began to dance. When people feel good, they dance. People who could not see were healed; those who could not walk, they got up and danced. Even those who could not taste or smell were healed with the rhythm of the drum.

We dedicate, we affirm, we hear the voice of God when the drum is beaten. In the drum are all the animals, plants, and natural things; there is lightning and thunder; everything is there in the sound of the drum. That is the way the story of the drum was told. The drum is a special gift to the people. The voice of Tunkashila, Grandfather, and all that is holy is in the drum—it is recreation for the people; when the drum sounds, the people become recreated with the heartbeat of the drum.

The world became contaminated with a smoke that came over the water; it came from the place we now call the Mediterranean Sea. The sound of the drum will clear this contamination; through the drum, a messenger can come and pray with that beating voice.

The sound of the drum is the sound of the Holy Mother. When men deny God and Holy Mother, when they say "God who are you?"—that is when the animals pray for us. Men want to create something different to God; men create nothing. Tunkashila sparks as spirit around the world; they offer their lives and their blood becomes stone. We make our sacred pipes from this stone.

Fire was the center of grandmother and grandfather and around the fire we drum. Here we contact our ancestors: we are not separate. We can bring this back with the drum, we bring back the spirit.

All people have drums; they make drums from wood, trees, and skin. Black, yellow, red and white—they all have drums, and we don't remember who had them first. The word drum means wooden bucket. It is also called She-he, because we all came out of the drum or womb in She, we all came out of woman.

When you were born, that is your second birthday. Before your second birthday, you were in She's womb, you were listening to the drumbeat of the great mother. That is why the drum is so healing because you remember, you go back into the safety of where you came from, you get reconnected to where you came from.